RR-P-386D
January 25, 1971
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. RR-P-386C
October 16, 1967

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PITCHERS, WATER: CORROSION-RESISTING STEEL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers corrosion-resisting steel water pitchers.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Sizes and styles. The water pitcher shall be of the following sizes and styles, as specified (see 6.2):

Size 1	-	1-quart capacity
Style A	-	Without cover
Style B	-	With hinged cover and ice guard
Size 2	-	2-quart capacity
Style A	-	Without cover
Style B	-	With removable cover
Size 3	-	3-quart capacity, without cover
Size 4	-	5-quart capacity, without cover

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

FSC 7350

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO., Ft. Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized and Containerized Unit Loads, 40" x 48" Pallets, Skids, Runners, or Pallet-Type Base.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard:

A167-63 - Corrosion-Resisting Chromium-Nickel Steel Plate, Sheet, and Strip.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19103).

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

National Sanitation Foundation (NSF) Standard:

No. 2 - Food Service Equipment.
Listing of Food Service Equipment.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Sanitation Foundation P. O. Box 1468, Ann Arbor Michigan, 48106.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Tariff Publishing Officer, Room 202 Union Station, 516 W. Jackson Blvd., Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. This specification contains provisions for first article test and approval (see 4.2, 6.2, and 6.4.)

3.2 Standard product. The water pitchers delivered under this specification shall be the manufacturer's standard current commercial product, except for any changes necessary to comply with specification requirements.

3.3 NSF standard. The water pitchers covered by this specification shall conform to the applicable requirements of NSF Standard No. 2.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.1 NSF certification. The supplier shall submit satisfactory evidence to the contracting officer or his authorized representative that the water pitchers he proposes to furnish meet the applicable requirements of NSF Standard No. 2 as follows:

(1) A listing in the current edition of the NSF "Listing of Food Service Equipment" or display of the NSF seal on the furnished water pitchers shall be submitted prior to approval of the preproduction sample, if one is submitted, or prior to approval of the first shipment, or

(2) A certification for the water pitchers issued by NSF under their special one-time contract evaluation/certification service shall be submitted prior to approval of the preproduction sample, if one is submitted, or prior to approval of the first shipment, or

(3) A certified test report from a recognized independent testing laboratory acceptable to the medical authority functioning in advisory capacity to the preparing agency of the specification indicating that the water pitchers have been tested and conform to NSF Standard No. 2 shall be submitted prior to the approval of the preproduction sample, if one is submitted, or prior to commencing production.

3.4 Materials. Materials not definitely specified shall be of the quality normally used by the manufacturer for water pitchers provided the completed items comply with all provisions of this specification.

3.4.1 Corrosion-resisting steel. Corrosion-resisting steel shall conform to the chemical composition of type 302 or 304 specified in ASTM A167-63.

3.5 Design and construction. The pitchers shall be designed to hold the capacities specified in table I (see 4.4.1). Sizes 1 and 2 shall be provided with or without a cover as shown in 1.2.1. Sizes 3 and 4 shall be provided without a cover. The pitchers shall be constructed of corrosion-resisting steel specified in 3.4.1 and shall consist of a body with pouring lip or spout, handle, and when required a cover. The size 1, style B pitcher shall have a hinged cover and ice guard. The size 2, style B pitcher shall have a removable cover. The empty water pitcher shall not topple over in any direction when tilted at a 20° angle from a normal vertical position (see 4.4.2). The water pitchers shall be designed so that water will begin pouring from the lip or spout when tilted between 3° to 30° and shall empty completely when tilted between 90° to 105° from the vertical position (4.4.3). Water pouring from the pitcher shall converge into a single round steam (see 4.4.3) leaving the spout.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.1 Metal thickness. All metal thicknesses specified hereinafter shall be the thickness after fabrication, except a 5 percent minus tolerance shall be allowed and material having metal thickness greater than specified herein shall be acceptable.

3.5.1.1 Body. The body of the pitchers shall be formed without seams from a single piece of corrosion-resisting steel specified in 3.4.1 and shall conform to the thickness shown in table I. The pitchers shall have an integral pouring spout or a separately formed pouring spout attached to the body. When the pitchers are constructed without a bead, the body thickness shall be 0.0344 inch for all the sizes (see 3.5.1 for tolerances).

3.5.2 Handle. The pitchers shall be fitted with a curved handle formed from a single piece of corrosion-resisting steel specified in 3.4.1 or formed from corrosion-resisting steel seamless or welded tube. The handle shall be positioned directly opposite the pouring spout, perpendicular to the bottom edge of the body. The top and bottom of the handle shall be welded to the body of the water pitcher. The handle shall not deform and welds shall not break when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

TABLE I. Dimensions

Pitcher		Body	Handle
Size	Capacity, quarts (Plus 10 percent minus 5 percent)	Thickness of bottom (inch)	Tubing wall thickness (inch)
1	1	0.0281	0.045
2	2	.0281	.045
3	3	.0281	.045
4	5	.0344	.045

3.5.3 Size 1, style B pitcher cover and ice guard. The cover for the size 1, style B pitcher shall be hinged and shall be fabricated from corrosion-resisting steel specified in 3.4.1. Thumb and hinge pads shall be spot welded or brazed to the cover. The body part of the hinge shall be made of corrosion-resisting steel 0.057 inch thick and spot welded or brazed to the body of the pitcher. One solid hinge pin not less than 1/8 inch diameter shall closely fit the holes with both ends upset or peened over the same diameter. The cover shall lay open at 180° in an inverted position allowing no strain on hinge assembly. The size 1, style B pitchers shall have an ice guard fabricated of corrosion-resisting steel specified in 3.4.1 or the ice guard may be a perforated section of the pitcher body in the spout area.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.4 Size 2, style B pitcher cover. Covers for the size 2, style B pitchers shall be removable and shall be fabricated from a single piece of corrosion-resisting steel specified in 3.4.1. The cover shall be recessed in the center handle area and shall have a flush type corrosion-resisting steel strap handle spot welded or brazed to the cover. The strap handle shall be centrally located on the outside surface of the cover.

3.6 Finish. After fabrication and removal of all rough and sharp edges the water pitchers shall be finished to meet the requirements of NSF Standard No. 2. The finished surfaces shall be free from discoloration or stains.

3.7 Marking. Each water pitcher shall be marked with the letters U. S. and the manufacturers name or trademark of such known character as to be readily identifiable with the manufacturer. Marking shall be applied in accordance with MIL-STD-130. The surface opposite the marking shall show no signs of penetration, unevenness, or distortion.

3.8 Workmanship. The finished water pitchers shall be clean and shall be free of burrs, slivers, scratches, rough die or gouge marks, pits, rust, or scale. The finished items shall not be fractured, buckled, bent, punctured, malformed, or damaged.

3.8.1 Welding. All surfaces to be welded shall be clean. Welding shall be accomplished in such a manner which will prevent the occurrence of pits, burn holes, flashes, fractures, undercuts, weld metal or base metal cracks, incomplete fusion, or slag inclusion. The welds shall be sound and smooth and shall blend into the contour of the handle. After any grinding there shall be no evidence of grind marks, discoloration, cracks or crevices. All scale or flux deposits shall be removed from the finished welds.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 First article inspection. When a preproduction sample is required, it shall be examined for defects listed in table II, dimensions specified, and tested as specified in 4.4.1, 4.4.2, 4.4.3, and 4.4.4. Failure to pass

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

test shall be cause for rejection of the preproduction sample. The sence of any defects listed in table II or any dimension not within cified requirement shall be cause for rejection of the preproduction sample.

.3 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be made in accordance with provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, unless otherwise indicated hereinafter.

.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components l materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the require- nts of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise cluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable rchase document.

4.3.2 Intermediate dimensional examination. Prior to the attachment of handle to the body, the wall thickness of the finished handle shall be amined for compliance with the requirement of 3.5.2 using inspection level 2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 6.5 defects, expressed in terms defects per hundred units. The lot shall consist of all handles offered r inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one handle.

4.3.3 End product inspection. The inspection lot shall consist of all the ter pitchers of the same size and style offered for inspection at one time. e sample unit for this inspection shall be one completely fabricated water tcher and if applicable, cover.

4.3.3.1 Visual examination. Examination shall be made of the end item r the defects classified in table II. The inspection level shall be level II th an AQL of 2.5 for major defects, and 6.5 for total defects, expressed in rms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Classification of defects

amine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
nish	Not as specified		X
	Evidence of discoloration, or stains	X	
nstruction and orkmanship (applicable to ll components nd assemblies)	Any burrs, slivers, or sharp edges, rough die, tool, gouge or grind marks	X	
	Any component fractured, buckled, bent, dented, punctured, malformed or damaged	X	
dy	Not formed from single piece of material	X	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Classification of defects (con.)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Covers (sizes 1 and 2, as applicable)	Not as specified	X	
	Removable cover not formed from single piece of materia	X	
	Not recessed in handle a	X	
	Cover missing	X	
	Cover handle missing	X	
	Handle on cover not flush type	X	
	Strap handle not centrally located on outside surface of cover	X	
Handle	Not directly opposite spout	X	
	Not perpendicular to bottom edge of body	X	
Welding	Missing, incomplete, or not fused	X	
	Any evidence of pits, burn holes, flashes, fractures, under cuts, weld metal or base cracks, incomplete fusion, or slag inclusion		X
	Fusion weld (where required) not sound, smooth, and doesn't blend into the contour of the handle		X
Identification marking	Missing, incomplete, illegible; not proper location		X
	Surface opposite marking shows penetration, unevenness, or distortion	X	

4.3.3.2 Dimensional examination. Examination shall be made of the pitchers to determine compliance with dimensions specified. Any deviation from specified requirements shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be level S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.3.3 Testing of the end item. When no preproduction sample is required the initial production unit shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1, 4.4.2, 4.4.3, and 4.4.4. Any nonconformance with specified requirements shall be cause for rejection. In addition the end item shall be tested as specified in 4.4.4 using an inspection level of S-2 with an AQL of 6.5 defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3.3.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking as required by section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be as indicated in table III. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0, expressed terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior and interior container)	Missing; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective
Contents	More or less than required

4.3.3.5 Examination of shipping container. When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure, waterproofing, and strapping shall be in accordance with PPP-B-636.

4.3.4 Examination of palletization. An examination shall be made to determine that palletization is in compliance with section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be as indicated in table IV. The sample unit for this examination shall be one palletized unit load ready for shipment. The lot shall be the number of palletized unit loads submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-1 with an AQL of 6.5 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Examination of palletization

Examination	Defect
Finished dimension	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Not as specified Pallet pattern not as specified Interlocking of loads not as specified Load not bonded with required straps specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

4.3.5 Code and standard compliance. Proof of compliance with the requirements of NSF (see 3.3) shall be submitted to the Government representative.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Capacity test. The water pitcher shall be filled with water. The water for each size pitcher shall then be emptied into a graduated beaker or container of known capacity and checked, one at a time, to determine compliance with the capacity requirements of table I and 3.5. Noncompliance shall constitute failure of this test.

4.4.2 Stability test. The empty water pitcher shall be placed on a flat horizontal surface and tilted at a 20° angle to determine compliance with the stability requirements of 3.5. Noncompliance shall constitute failure of this test.

4.4.3 Pouring test. The water pitchers shall be filled with water and tilted at an angle of 3° to 30° and then to an angle of 90° to 105° to determine compliance with the water pouring requirements specified in 3.5. During the test, the flow of water from the pouring lip or spout shall be checked to determine compliance with the stream convergence requirements of 3.5. Noncompliance shall constitute failure of this test.

4.4.4 Handle test. The water pitcher shall be loaded with weights equivalent to 1-1/4 times the weight of the water the item is intended to hold and lifted by the handle to a position of normal use. The water pitcher shall then be examined for conformance with the deformation and weld requirements of 3.5.2. Noncompliance shall constitute failure of this test.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each pitcher shall be packaged upright in a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to style RSC, type CF, variety SW, or type SF, class domestic of PPP-B-636. When covers are specified for the 2-quart pitcher, each cover shall be wrapped in kraft paper having a minimum basis weight of 10 pounds (25 x 26 - 500), or nominal 0.0015 inch thick polyethylene and put in place on the pitcher. Each box shall be closed in accordance with PPP-B-636.

5.1.2 Level C. Each pitcher shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Thirty-six of 1- or 2- quart capacity, twelve of the 3-quart capacity, or eight of the 5-quart capacity pitchers packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, V2s of PPP-B-636. Closure, waterproofing by means of tape, and reinforcing with flat strapping or tape banding shall be in accordance with PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Thirty-six of 1- or 2- quart capacity, twelve of the 3-quart capacity, or eight of the 5-quart capacity pitchers, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF, variety SW, or type SF, class domestic of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with method II of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s, fabricated and closed in accordance with PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. Pitchers, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Palletization, military requirements. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), pitchers packed as specified shall be palletized in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.4.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The water pitchers covered by this specification are intended for use in serving beverages.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size and style required (see 1.2.1).
(c) First article (see 3.1, 4.2, and 6.4).
(d) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard is required for level B shipment (see 5.2.2.1).
(e) Selection of the applicable level of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) When palletization is not required (see 5.3).

6.3 Standard pack (civil agencies). The standard pack for this commodity shall be as specified in 5.1.1 and 5.2.2. The standard pack requirements are intended for use in procurement of stores stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements, when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot, or immediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue, and/or shipment to eventual user.

6.4 First article. The item covered by this specification requires first article test and approval under the appropriate provisions of paragraph 7-104.55 of the Armed Services Procurement Regulations. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The first article should consist of one unit. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments, regarding arrangements for examination, test and approval of the first article.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.5 Supersession data. The style A designation for the size 3 and size 4 water pitchers have been dropped in this specification since these water pitchers are furnished without covers.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 84

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

CIVIL AGENCIES INTEREST:

GSA-FSS
VA
HEW

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.